

OAS-016 — Decision Architecture

Status: Foundational

Authority: Architectural

Depends on:

- OAS-000 through OAS-015
 - OCS-000 through OCS-032
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Purpose

This specification defines the architectural organization of Decisions.

The Constitution defines what a Decision is.

This specification defines how Decisions are architecturally organized so they remain explainable, reversible, historically attributable, and continuously improvable.

Architecture SHALL preserve the entire life of a Decision.

Not merely its outcome.

1. Architectural Objective

The objective of Decision Architecture is to ensure that every Decision remains permanently connected to the constitutional understanding from which it emerged.

Architecture SHALL preserve:

Purpose.

Alternatives.

Reasoning.

Evidence.

Uncertainty.

Consequences.

Review.

Learning.

2. Decision Emergence

A Decision SHALL emerge from constitutional interaction.

Architecture SHALL preserve the following progression.

```text id="6nk5s0" Question

↓

Understanding

↓

Reasoning

↓

Decision

↓

Action

↓

Observation

↓

Learning ```

No architectural shortcut SHALL bypass this progression without explicit constitutional justification.

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### 3. Architectural Independence

Decision Architecture SHALL remain independent of:

Voting systems.

Governance models.

Artificial intelligence providers.

Workflow engines.

Organizational structures.

These MAY implement Decisions.

They SHALL NOT define them.

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### 4. Decision Identity

Every Decision SHALL possess:

Architectural identity.

Historical lineage.

Context.

Relationships.

Review history.

Identity SHALL survive architectural evolution.

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### 5. Decision Relationships

Decisions SHALL preserve explicit relationships to:

Questions.

Evidence.

Voices.

Conversations.

Understanding.

Actions.

Subsequent Decisions.

Relationships SHALL remain reconstructable.

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## **6. Decision Alternatives**

Architecture SHALL preserve all constitutionally significant alternatives.

Alternatives SHALL remain:

Visible.

Explainable.

Historically attributable.

Future investigators SHALL understand why they were not selected.

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## **7. Decision Review**

Every Decision SHALL remain reviewable.

Review SHALL preserve:

Original understanding.

New understanding.

Reasons for change.

Applicable evidence.

Historical continuity.

Review SHALL become architectural history.

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## 8. Decision Reversibility

Architecture SHALL distinguish:

Reversible Decisions.

Partially reversible Decisions.

Irreversible Decisions.

Architectural organization SHALL preserve this distinction.

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## 9. Decision Memory

Decision Memory SHALL preserve:

Intent.

Reasoning.

Evidence.

Consequences.

Subsequent observations.

Future revisions.

Decision Memory SHALL survive implementation replacement.

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## 10. Decision Federation

Federated Places MAY reference one another's Decisions.

References SHALL preserve:

Origin.

Local context.

Applicable understanding.

Architectural relationships.

Federation SHALL not transfer ownership.

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## 11. Decision Verification

Verification SHALL demonstrate:

Reasoning preservation.

Relationship preservation.

Historical reconstruction.

Architectural continuity.

Equivalent constitutional decision behavior.

Implementation SHALL remain replaceable.

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## 12. Decision Pattern

Architecture SHALL organize Decisions as evolving constitutional commitments rather than immutable commands.

Commands terminate execution.

Decisions initiate learning.

Architecture SHALL preserve learning.

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## 13. Decision Architecture Test

Decision Architecture satisfies this specification when an independent architect can reconstruct:

Why the Decision existed.

Which alternatives were available.

Which evidence mattered.

Which reasoning prevailed.

What happened afterward.

How future understanding may revise the Decision.

Without relying on implementation-specific workflow.

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## Conformance

An implementation conforms to this specification when every Decision remains architecturally connected to its constitutional origin, historical evolution, reasoning, evidence, and subsequent learning independently of implementation technology.

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## Architectural Principle

A command ends a conversation.

A constitutional decision begins one.

Architecture therefore treats every Decision not as the conclusion of understanding,

but as the beginning of the next cycle of observation,

learning,

and deeper constitutional understanding.

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**End of Specification OAS-016**